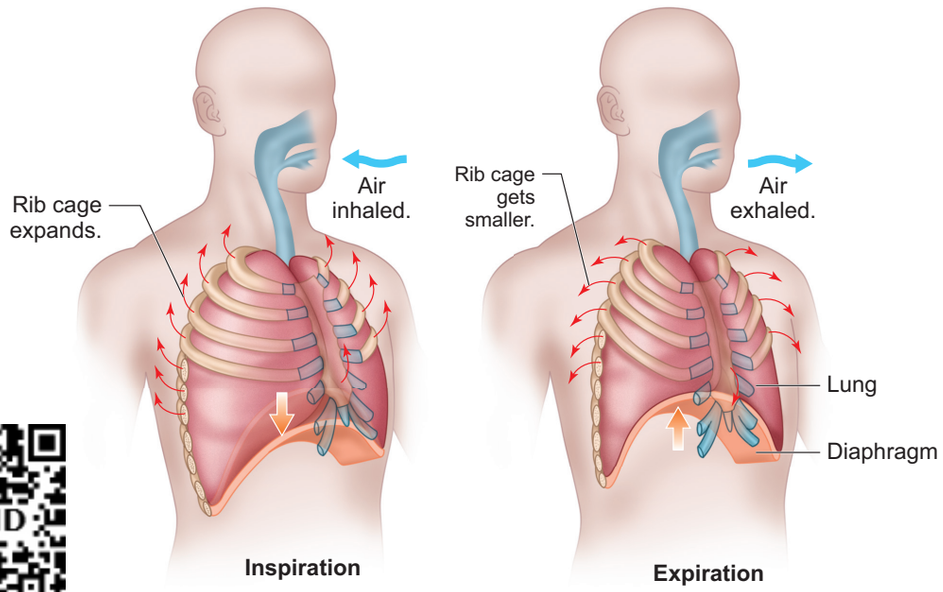


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Figure 6.4 Mechanism of breathing

Events in inspiration and expiration

Inspiration	Expiration
Respiratory centre initiates the stimuli during inspiration. ↓ The diaphragm and external intercostal muscles contract. ↓ The thoracic volume increases as the chest wall expands. ↓ The intra pulmonary pressure is reduced. ↓ The alveolar pressure decreases than the atmospheric pressure ↓ Air is taken inside due to expansion of alveoli. ↓ Air flows into the alveoli until the alveolar pressure equalizes the atmospheric pressure and the alveoli get inflated.	Respiratory centre terminates the stimuli during expiration. ↓ The diaphragm relax but internal intercostal muscles contract. ↓ The thoracic volume decreases as the chest wall contracts. ↓ The intra pulmonary pressure is increased. ↓ The alveolar pressure increases than the atmospheric pressure. ↓ Air is sent out due to the contraction of alveoli. ↓ Air flows out of the alveoli until the alveolar pressure equalizes the atmospheric pressure and the alveoli get deflated.

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